Sustainability Training follow-up resource

This guide supports the delivery of the training presentation and helps facilitators engage participants through discussion, examples, and activities.

1. Training Objective

By the end of the session, participants should:

- Understand what sustainability means for community projects.
- Identify four key ways to build sustainability**.**
- Begin thinking about how their own project can become sustainable.

The presentation introduces sustainability as ensuring that a project can continue helping people even when outside support ends.

2. Suggested Training Structure

Section	Time	Method
Introduction to Sustainability	10 minutes	Discussion
Four Sustainability Strategies	40 minutes	Explanation + examples
Group Activity	20 minutes	Small group discussion
Building a Sustainability Plan	15 minutes	Guided reflection
Wrap-Up & Questions	5–10 minutes	Open discussion

Total Suggested Time: **1.5 hours**

3. Opening discussion (Before Slide Content)

Ask participants:

Question 1

What happens to many community projects after donors stop funding them?

Explain:

Sustainability means planning from the beginning so the project can continue working even without outside support.

4. Explaining Sustainability (Slide Section)

Explain that sustainability is about:

- Long-term survival of projects
- Independence from one source of funding
- Community ownership
- Creating systems that support the work over time

Key message:

A sustainable project does not depend only on donations.

Ask participants:

Reflection Question

What would make your project continue even if funding stopped tomorrow?

5. Strategy 1: Income Generation

Explain clearly:

Income generation means creating **activities that bring money into the project**.

Examples from the slides include:

- Selling products
- Charging small service fees
- Renting space or equipment

Facilitator Discussion Questions

Ask participants:

1. What products or services could your organization sell?
2. What skills already exist in your group?
3. What resources do you already have that could generate income?

Activity (5 minutes)

Ask participants to list:

- One product

- One service
- One asset

their organization could use to generate income.

6. Strategy 2: Social Business

Explain:

A social business (social enterprise) is a business that:

1. Solves a community problem
2. Generates income to sustain the organization

Key concept:

Profit is used to support the mission, not just personal gain.

Facilitator Discussion Questions

Ask participants:

- What community problem exists in your area?
- Could a business solution help solve it?

Example prompts

Participants might consider:

- Water purification services
- Agricultural training centers
- Community tutoring services
- Recycling businesses

7. Strategy 3: Community Support

Explain that sustainability also comes from local ownership.

When community members contribute:

- They feel the project belongs to them
- They want it to succeed
- The project becomes stronger

Examples

Discuss possible local support methods:

- Community fundraising events
- Membership programs
- Local business partnerships

Facilitator Question

Why do people support projects they feel they own?

8. Strategy 4: Diversified Funding

Explain this idea using the table with many legs' analogy.

If one funding source stops:

- The project continues through others.

Examples of funding sources:

- Individual donations
- Grants
- Membership fees
- Product sales
- Fundraising events

Facilitator Activity

Ask participants to draw a simple diagram of their funding sources.

Then ask:

Do you depend on one source or many?

9. Group Exercise (Key Activity)

Divide participants into small groups.

Each group should answer:

1. What is one income activity your project could start?
2. What is one social business idea?

3. How could your community contribute?
4. What three funding sources could support your project?

Ask groups to briefly share their ideas.

10. Building a Sustainability Plan

Explain the four simple steps shown in the presentation:

1. Start a small income activity
2. Involve the community
3. Find different funding sources
4. Grow a social business over time

Important message:

Sustainability does not happen instantly. It grows step by step.

Encourage participants to start small but consistently.

11. Key Messages to Reinforce

Before closing the training, emphasize:

- Sustainability is about long-term thinking.
- Community ownership is very powerful.
- Income generation reduces dependence on donors.
- Diversifying funding increases stability.

12. Closing Reflection

Ask participants:

1. What is one sustainability idea you will try after this training?
2. What first step can you take in the next 30 days?

Let a few volunteers share.

13. Optional Homework for Participants

Ask them to prepare a simple sustainability plan, including:

- One income activity

- One community engagement strategy
- Two additional funding sources

They can present this at the next meeting.